

EDUCATION

PhD, University of Minnesota <i>Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences</i>	Expected May 2027
MS, Minnesota State University, Mankato <i>Communication Disorders</i>	2019
BS, University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire <i>Communication Sciences & Disorders</i> <i>Latin American Studies</i>	2017

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Speech-Language Pathologist St. Francis Area Schools	2020-2022
Black River Falls School District	2019-2020

PUBLICATIONS

First Author

Vruwink, O., Gregory, S. K., Rawls, E., Willis, C., & Kemp, A. M. (*submitted*). Stories that Speak Back: Participatory Dissemination Through Art After Brain Injury. *Journal of Participatory Research Methods*.

Contributing Author

Covington, N. V., Friedman, S., Klukas, C., Becker, N., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (2025). Open Notes in Brain Injury Rehabilitation Part 2: Patient and Provider Preferences for Artificial Intelligence Solutions. *Archives of Physical Medicine & Rehabilitation*.

Covington, N. V., Friedman, S., Klukas, C., Becker, N., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (2025). Open Notes in Brain Injury Rehabilitation Part 1: Contrasting Perspectives of Patients and Providers. *Archives of Physical Medicine & Rehabilitation*.

Covington, N. V. & **Vruwink, O.** (2025). Potential Impacts of ChatGPT in Undergraduate Education: Performance of GPT-3.5 and Identification of AI-Generated Text in Introductory Neuroscience. *International Journal of Artificial Intelligence in Education*.

Covington, N. V., **Vruwink, O.**, & Radomski, M. V. (2025) Purpose in Life after Brain Injury: Expanding the Focus and Impact of Interdisciplinary Rehabilitation. *American Journal of Speech-Language Pathology*.

Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (2025). Finding a "NEW VOICE to tell my story" through the Unmasking Brain Injury project: a mixed-method analysis of wellness after brain injury. *Disability and Rehabilitation*.

Arzbecker, L. J., Blacklock, E. A., Crumb, A. M., Doyle, J. D., Esveld, M., Grelson, S. L., Gretzinger, B., Korpela, A., Kressin, K. A., Pakanich, L. M., Pulley, T. L., Nolte Rierdon, N. L., Spreitzer, K. A., Steines, E. L., Strom, B. J., Symons, E. C., Vogelsang, M., **Vruwink, O. N.**, Weberg, K. L., ...

Elledge, D. H. (2018). SoTL Lab: Undergraduate student-faculty collaborative research in teaching and learning in CSD. *Teaching and Learning in Communication Sciences & Disorders*, 2(2).

PRESENTATIONS

Invited

Vruwink, O. (June 2026). Practice Case Illustrating Identity Reconstruction After Brain Injury Through Social Engagement [Invited 1-hour oral presentation]. Saugatuck Institute for Neuropsychological Rehabilitation (SINR) – Saugatuck, MI.

First Author

Vruwink, O., Smith, L., & Covington, N. V. (November 2025). *Living with Purpose: Perspectives from Adults with Acquired Brain Injury* [30-minute oral presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Washington, D.C.

Vruwink, O. & Covington, N. V. (March 2025). *Relationships between Healthcare Utilization Preferences and Hypothetical Rehabilitation Treatment Decisions: Implications for Patient Education* [Poster]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Vruwink, O., McCurdy, R., Walsh, K., Duff, M. C., & Covington, N. V. (March 2025). *Expected Outcomes of Traumatic Brain Injury Rehabilitation: Insights and Perspectives from Care Partners* [Poster]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Vruwink, O. & Covington, N. V. (September 2024). *Going Beyond “Return to Baseline”: Perspectives on Recovery After Traumatic Brain Injury from Patients & Their Care Partners* [Poster]. Eleanor M. Saffran Conference on Cognitive Neuroscience & Rehabilitation of Communication Disorders – Philadelphia, PA.

Vruwink, O., Grabowski, A., McCurdy, R., Duff, M. C., & Covington, N. V. (November 2023) *Measuring What Matters: Converging and Diverging Perspectives of Clinicians and Adults with TBI* [Poster]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Boston, MA.

Contributing Author

O’Brien, K. H., Pei, Y., **Vruwink, O.,** Becker, N., Klukas, C., Covington, N. V. (January 2026). “*Read anything good lately?*”: Evidence for Reduced Engagement with Leisure Texts after Brain Injury [Oral presentation]. International Cognitive-Communication Disorders Conference (ICCDC) – Nashville, TN.

Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.,** Willis, C., Rawls, E. (January 2026). *Then and Now: Using Arts-Based Reflection to Explore Self-Awareness Across a Decade of Living with Brain Injury* [Oral presentation]. International Cognitive-Communication Disorders Conference (ICCDC) – Nashville, TN.

Covington, N. V., Friedman, S., Klukas, C., Becker, N., **Vruwink, O.,** & O’Brien, K. H. (November 2025). *Artificial Intelligence in Brain Injury Rehabilitation in the Open Notes Era: Opportunities and Challenges* [1-hour oral presentation]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Washington, D.C.

Covington, N. V., **Vruwink, O.,** Schaefer, W., Demmers, N., & Kocian, A. (March 2025). *Personalized Cognitive Rehabilitation: Preliminary Results of a Proof-of-Concept Study* [Poster]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

- Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, Callahan, B., Rawls, E., & O'Brien, K. H. (March 2025). *Towards Wellness in Acquired Brain Injury Through Storytelling: The Unmasking Brain Injury Project* [Poster]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.
- Rawls, E., Gregory, S. K., **Vruwink, O.**, Callahan, B., O'Brien, K. H., & Kemp, A. M. (March 2025). *Unmasking Brain Injury: Using Art to Navigate Emotional Experiences in Acquired Brain Injury* [Poster]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.
- Covington, N. V., Radomski, M. V., Castro-Pearson, S., Canavati, H., Herrmann, A., Howe, C., Kath, K., Kocian, A., Kreiger, R., Reger, L., Schwalbe, S., **Vruwink, O.**, Wagener, S., & Zola, J. (March 2025). *Purpose Renewal after Brain Injury: Results of a Feasibility Study* [Poster]. International Brain Injury Association World Congress – Montreal, Quebec, Canada.
- Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, Gregory, S. K., & O'Brien, K. H. (April 2024). *Art as a tool for supporting wellness after acquired brain injury*. [Oral Presentation]. Brain Injury Professional Conference, Brooklyn Center, MN.
- Covington, N. V., **Vruwink, O.**, & Radomski, M. (January 2024) *Purpose in Daily Life: An Interdisciplinary Proposal for Promoting Flourishing after Brain Injury* [Panel]. International Cognitive-Communication Disorders Conference (ICCDC) – Orange, CA.
- Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (November 2023). *Using Storytelling to Reflect on Experiences with Acquired Brain Injury: The Unmasking Project* [Poster]. American Congress of Rehabilitation Medicine (ACRM) Conference – Atlanta, GA.
- Covington, N. V. & **Vruwink, O.** (November 2023) *Large Language Models in Higher Education: Performance of ChatGPT in Undergraduate Neuroscience* [1-hour seminar]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Boston, MA.
- Kemp, A. M., **Vruwink, O.**, & O'Brien, K. H. (November 2023). *The Story of Acquired Brain Injury: A Mixed-Method Analysis of Autobiographical Narratives from ABI Survivors* [30-minute technical research session]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Boston, MA.
- Covington, N. V. & **Vruwink, O.** (November 2022). *Preparation for Careers Beyond the Clinic: Maximizing the Value of CSD Coursework for All Undergraduates* [Poster]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – New Orleans, LA.
- Mahowald, M. C., Krenik, E., **Vruwink, O.**, Spicer, B., & Burk, B. (November 2018). *Camp Maverick: An Interprofessional Collaboration to Improve Literacy & Wellbeing among Youth* [Poster]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Boston, MA.
- Hoepner, J. K., Hemmerich, A. L., Elledge, D., Zigler, E., Grelson, S., **Vruwink, O.**, Strom, B., Nolte Rierdon, N., Doyle, J., & Wolosek, A., (November 2017). *What are the Active Ingredients in Your Teaching Toolbox?* [1-hour seminar]. American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention – Los Angeles, CA.

University-Level Presentations

- Vruwink, O.**, Hoepner, J. K., Pratt, J. (May 2017). *Portability of the Sandwich modified flipped classroom approach in information systems* [Oral seminar]. Provost's Honors Symposium – University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire.

Vruwink, O., Strom, B., Terrell, R., Hoepner, J. K., Pratt, J., & Hemmerich, A. L. (May 2017). *Portability of the Sandwich modified flipped classroom approach in information system* [Poster]. Celebration of Excellence in Research & Creative Activity – University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire.

HONORS / SCHOLARSHIPS

- Student Scholar Award, Eleanor M. Saffran Center for Cognitive Neuroscience (2024, 2025)
- Eleanor Swanson Memorial Scholarship, Minnesota Speech-Language-Hearing Foundation (2024)
- Bryng Bryngelson Research Funding Award, SLHS Department at University of Minnesota (2022, 2024)
- Research Mentoring-Pair Travel Award, American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (2023)
- Brain Injury ISIG David Strauss PhD Memorial Poster Award, American Congress of Rehabilitation Medicine (2023)
- Communicative Disorders Scholarship, Sertoma Inc. (2023)
- Thank a Teacher Recipient, Center for Educational Innovation at University of Minnesota (2023)
- Conference Travel Grant, Council of Graduate Students at University of Minnesota (2022)
- Excellence in Service-Learning Award, University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire (2017)
- Student Staff Award, University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire (2016)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Minnesota Graduate Instructor of Record

Language and Cognitive Disorders in Adults (SLHS 5605)

March–May 2025

Intro to Neuroscience of Human Communication (SLHS 4301)

Fall 2024

University of Minnesota Guest Lectures

- SLHS 5606 Introduction to Augmentative and Alternative Communication, Instructor of Record: Katlyn McGrattan, PhD CCC-SLP, Topic: School-Based AAC Parts I & II (Spring 2023)
- SLHS 4301 Intro to Neuroscience of Human Communication, Instructor of Record: Natalie Covington, PhD CCC-SLP, Topics: Resting Membrane Potential & Overview to Speech & Voice (Fall 2023, 2022)

University of Minnesota Teaching Assistant

- SLHS 4301 Introduction to the Neuroscience of Human Communication, Instructor of Record: Natalie Covington, PhD CCC-SLP (Fall 2025, 2023, 2022)
- SLHS 1302 Rate Your World: Quantifying Judgments of Human Behavior, Instructor of Record: Yang Zhang, PhD (Spring 2025)
- SLHS 3306 The Sense of Hearing, Instructor of Record: Robert Schlauch, PhD (Spring 2023, 2024)
- SLHS 3302 Anatomy & Physiology of the Speech & Hearing Mechanisms, Instructor of Record: Yang Zhang, PhD (Fall 2023)
- SLHS 3402W Capstone Project in Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences, Instructor of Record: Jayanthi Sasisekaran, PhD (Spring 2023)
- SLHS 3305W Speech Science, Instructor of Record: Peter Watson, PhD (Fall 2022)

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Speech-Language Pathologist

August 2024

True Friends Brain Gains Camp | Camp Courage in Maple Lake, MN

Assisted in development of a five-day didactic and interactive group curriculum appropriate for adults with moderate-severe acquired brain injury related to purpose in life after brain injury. Facilitated a majority of the curriculum at the Brain Gains camp at Camp Courage, in collaboration with Allina Health occupational therapists. Supervised MA-SLP student intern.

Volunteer- Chippewa Valley Aphasia Camp YMCA Camp Manitou/University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire	September 2016
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AmeriCorps Member- Blugold Beginnings University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire	2015-2016
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Student Coordinator- Civil Rights Pilgrimage University of Wisconsin-Eau Claire	2014-2016
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SERVICE

- SLHS Program Co-Representative, Council of Graduate Students at University of Minnesota (Fall 2024–Spring 2025)
- Grant Review, Council of Graduate Students at University of Minnesota (Summer 2024, Spring 2023)
- Mentored Review, *Journal of Speech-Language Hearing Research* (Spring 2024)
- Mentored Review, *Perspectives of the ASHA Special Interest Groups* (Summer 2023)

LICENSURE / CERTIFICATION

Licensed Speech-Language Pathologist (#518043) Minnesota Department of Health	2021-Present
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Certificate of Clinical Competence & Member (#14132271) American Speech-Language-Hearing Association	2020-Present
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